



June 27th, 2017 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rXq19ANk7Ck
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: June 27 (Year not explicitly stated)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order by the presiding officer [00:00:10](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Alexander, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Mr. Matchett, Ms. Piper, and Mr. Drugmand (variously referred to in transcript audio).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in the opening transcript, but leading the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The council recited the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States [00:00:18](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the May 23rd meeting were presented and approved via roll call vote [00:01:23](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:05:32 Financial Agenda: New Appropriations (Community Corrections & Cumulative Bridge)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by Ron / Council staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of state-approved grant funds and fee funds for Community Corrections (Adult, Transition Program, User Fee Fund) totaling various requests (including Adult fund request of \$892,364; Transition Program at \$31,677; User Fee Fund at \$1,003,358). Additionally, Cumulative Bridge Fund 701 requested \$100,000 for construction/rehab of Bridge 701 on Water Street over White River for summer construction.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:08:27 EMS Ambulance Replacement & Capital Improvement Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers, Emergency Management Director for Delaware County.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to split a total cost of \$122,010 to remount an ambulance box with Road Industries across two accounts: EMS Ambulance Replacement Fund (\$61,455) and EMS Capital Improvement Fund 443 (\$61,455), ensuring neither account is completely emptied.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:09:50 Special Distribution State Grant Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council staff / Auditor's office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriating \$664,530.48 received from a special state distribution/grant.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:12:08 Financial Agenda: Transfers (9-1-1, EMS, Jail, Courts, Highway, Public Defender Addendum)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department heads and council staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed various line-item transfers and corrections, including 9-1-1 communication fund adjustments, EMS salary reallocations, jail staffing line corrections, court travel expenses, highway department transfers, and an addendum for a new public defender employee (Emily Anderson/Mindy's office) needing salary ordinance alignment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator) spoke regarding public defender/court staffing needs [00:26:17](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with light reductions and salary ordinance amendments by Roll Call Vote.

- **00:19:08 Community Corrections: Second Director's Salary Adjustment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** C.C. Financial Manager / Jeff Arnold (Delaware County Prosecutor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a \$7,500 raise for the second director (effective May 10 through June 30) to bring the position in line with probation officer salaries, following a previous pay decrease when taking the Community Corrections director role.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Jeff Arnold testified that the salary adjustment was part of original employment negotiations and is supported by the advisory board and state grant.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
 - **00:29:45 Joint Resolution Regarding Syringe and Needle Distribution Programs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Attorney (Mr. Hughes).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council discussed a drafted joint resolution expressing opposition to establishing a syringe and needle distribution program. The County Attorney noted that the Commissioners declined to join the resolution, and since the council is a fiscal body (not legislative) with no current funding request before them for such a program, he recommended setting the resolution aside until an actual funding request is made.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to consider made and seconded, but **Died for lack of a majority/further action** (motion failed/died) **00:32:07**.
 - **00:32:10 Amendments to Sheriff's Employee Pension Plan (DROP Program & Vesting)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Attorney / Captain Bill Goodwin (Sheriff's Department).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion on proposed amendments to the Delaware County Police Retirement Plan (adding a DROP program and adjusting vesting/age provisions). The County Attorney recommended tabling the amendment because the county is entering collective bargaining negotiations with the police bargaining unit, and altering retirement/compensation benefits unilaterally could violate bargaining agreements. Captain Bill Goodwin and council members debated the actuarial safety, sunset clauses, and state approvals.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Captain Bill Goodwin spoke on behalf of the Sheriff's Department regarding negotiations and pension structure **00:34:45**.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Tabled** pending completion of the collective bargaining process (Approved to table by roll call vote) **00:41:09**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: Major presentations during the meeting functioned similarly to informational forums, including updates from officials): - [00:41:53](#) **Jeff Arnold (Delaware County Prosecutor):** Reported on the successful first year of the federally/state-funded Domestic Violence Unit, noting that case filings doubled while dismissal rates dropped from 41% to 7%. He announced the receipt of a new grant for an additional attorney and investigator to expand into City Court, requiring a 25% local match (~\$28,000 / \$55,000 gross with reimbursements) starting July 1st. A special meeting was requested to handle the grant acceptance before the deadline. - [00:54:37](#) **Mrs. Arrington (State Representative / Former Council Member):** Addressed the council, thanking them and reflecting on her start in elected office on the County Council.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - A special meeting was scheduled for **July 18 at 9:00 AM** to consider the Prosecutor's grant request [00:53:57](#).
 - Budget hearing schedules for September (following Labor Day) and October budget adoption dates were discussed with the auditor [00:59:02](#).
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded with a motion to adjourn, which was seconded and approved [00:37:37 / 01:09:34].
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